to European integration came in 1946 with Winston Churchill's call for a "United States of Europe". The ultimate outcome of his speech was the establishment of the Council of Europe in 1949 as the first pan-European organization. Although the Council of Europe was only a limited form of European cooperation, nevertheless, it served as a stimulus for future integration.

On 9 May 1950, the French Foreign Minister, Robert Schuman proposed a community to integrate the coal and steel industries of France and West Germany under a common High Authority. The goal of the proposed community was that France, Italy, West Germany, and the Benelux countries could share the strategic resources in order to "make war not only unthinkable but materially impossible", and to build lasting peace in Europe. The objective of such an integration was made clear in the Schuman Declaration which stated, "the pooling of coal and steel production should immediately provide for the setting up of common foundations for economic development as a first step in the federation of Europe, and will change the destinies of those regions which have long been devoted to the manufacture of munitions of war, of which they have been most constant victims".[18]

The realization of this proposal led to the creation of the European Coal and Steel Community (ECSC) by the Treaty of Paris (1951) and, on 18 April 1951, the leaders of the six member countries signed a European Declaration stating that the signing of this Treaty marked the true foundation of an organized Europe.

The resulting ECSC introduced a common, single steel and coal market, with freely set market prices, and without import/export duties or subsidies. The success of ECSC led to further steps of integration. Leaders met at the Messina Conference and established the Spaak Committee which produced the Spaak report. The report was accepted at the Venice Conference (29 and 30 May 1956). Finally, on the basis of the report, the Intergovernmental Conference on the Common Market and Euratom focussing on economic unity was held. This led to the signing of Treaties of Rome in 1957 which established the European Economic Community (EEC) and the European Atomic Energy Community (Euratom) among the